like Gujarat, Haryana, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Uttar Pradesh also have high decadal growth of population.

In 2011, Kerala has the *highest sex ratio* with 1084 females per 1000 males, followed by Tamil Nadu (995), while Haryana is at the bottom (877). Interestingly, the sex-ratios in some of the developed states like Gujarat and Maharashtra are also low at 918 and 925, respectively.

Growth Related

The *best performers* in terms of growth during 2011-12 are *Bihar* (**16.71** per cent) followed by Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra. The growth of these states is much above the all India average. The *worst performers* are Rajasthan (5.41 per cent) followed by Punjab and Uttar Pradesh. States with the highest growth rate for the period 2005-06 to 2011-12 are *Bihar* (**10.17** per cent) followed by Gujarat and Maharashtra. In terms of growth in *per capita income*, the best performer is *Bihar* (**15.44** per cent) followed by Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra due to high growth in gross state domestic product (GSDP) in 2011-12 and despite their high decadal growth in population. Per capita income growth is the lowest in Rajasthan (3.72 per cent), followed by Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and Odisha which are all below the all India per capita income growth.

Poverty

The poverty estimates indicate that the *highest* poverty headcount ratio (HCR) exists in *Bihar* at 53.5 per cent as against the national average of 29.8 per cent. In 2009-10 compared to 2004-5, Bihar has displaced Odisha as the poorest state, Socio-Economic and Caste Census (SECC) with Odisha's situation improving considerably in 2009-10. Lowest poverty is in Himachal Pradesh (9.5 per cent) followed by Kerala (12 per cent).

Rural-Urban Disparity

Bihar has the lowest MPCE both in rural and urban areas at Rs. 780 (with 65 per cent food share) and Rs.1238 (with 53 per cent food share) respectively. In comparison, Kerala has the highest in both rural and urban areas at Rs.1835 (with 46 per cent food share) and Rs. 2413 (with 40 per cent food share), respectively. It is obvious that poorer states spend a greater proportion of income on food in total consumption expenditure.

Unemployment